linked to Arabs and Muslims, and Islam is portrayed as fostering terrorism. Students of Arab descent and Muslim faith feel targeted and demonized by these depictions; interviews of these students show that they reject what is conveyed in the texts and disconnect from the lessons that draw on these readings. The politics of "terrorism" used to indiscriminately target Arab Americans and Muslim Americans leads to the alienation of young people in these communities and risks making them feel like unwelcome guests in their own country (Aslan 2010).

58

Transnationalism

Lan P. Duong

"Transnationalism" is a term used in many disciplines: the social sciences, anthropology, sociology, international law, economics, feminist studies, and cultural studies. A prominent keyword in these fields, it is nonetheless a contested term. Although there have always been the transnational phenomena of migration and movement, transnationalism—as it is commonly used today—expresses a contemporary condition, one that is vitally associated with a post-Fordist economy, finance capital, and flexible accumulation. This is especially marked in the ways that globalized corporations, large-scale flows of capital and information, and migratory workforces have become more dominant within late capitalist modernity. In this context, transnationalism refers to a profoundly felt interconnectivity between people and places. It gestures toward the ways in which people, ideas, and goods traverse regions or nation-states, the interconnections of which have been intensified by twenty-first-century modes of telecommunications and transportation that enable the hyperswift crisscrossing of both commodities and capital. Arising from these processes, studies of the transnational tend to decentralize the nation-state as an analytic framework within which to study the modes of culture, history, and people that are formed and reformed transnationally.

Particularly within the social sciences, transnationalism encapsulates recent migration patterns that highlight the multiple arrivals and leave taking of migrants

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who are moving and resettling for a variety of reasons. As a result of such traffic, transnational migrants may have various alliances to different countries simultaneously in a dynamic of the "here" and "there" that is a part of the transnational condition. Such subjects may also develop a conglomeration of (filial, affective, economic, and organizational) networks as a consequence. For many scholars, a transnational paradigm recognizes the intricate mapping of social experience across axes of time and space and allows for a broader understanding of the ways in which cultures and identities circulate both nationally and transnationally.

However, it is precisely because of transnationalism's elasticity in explaining such an expansive range of phenomena that some researchers have also attempted to critique the ways that transnational modes of analysis fail to capture the complexities of state powers and their relation to the transnational subject (Waldinger and Fitzgerald 2004). With an uncritical notion of transnationalism and a lack of proper historicization of the transnational, moreover, its usage may lead to celebrations of mobility, hybridity, and cosmopolitanism. In the wake of the term's popular currency, scholars have further qualified "transnationalism" as it contrasts to and may be coupled with other terms, such as "diaspora," "globalization," and "feminism."

In looking at the ways that transnationalism differs from diaspora, Jana Braziel and Anita Mannur (2003) underscore the affective qualities of being a diasporan. They explain that the diasporic experience describes people and communities that have been displaced, with migrations that tend to be more forced than voluntary. Transnationalism, in contrast, alludes to a more abstract discourse that underscores the circulation of people as well as information, goods, and capital across national territories. For Braziel and Mannur, diaspora enables a rethinking of what it means to deterritorialize, draw the bounds of community, and define the terms of citizenship.

Others have delineated how transnationalism works in contradistinction to globalization. As Françoise Lionnet and Shu-mei Shih (2005) argue, the transnational and the global are spatially different; globalization assumes a universal core from which everything spreads outward, while transnationalism locates particular sites of exchange and hybridity. Moving away from the binaries of local and global, the transnational is thus constitutive of the center and periphery, across multiple spatialities and temporalities. For these authors, this quality of transnationalism opens a critical and productive space for analyses of a "minor transnationalism," which looks at the resistant mode of minorities across different texts and contexts within a comparative frame.

Another way in which transnationalism has been qualified is through the lens of feminism. Inderpal Grewal and Caren Kaplan (1994) distinguish earlier feminisms like global and international feminism from a formulation of transnational feminism that does not align all women together. Transnational feminists contend that feminist scholars must always consider the crucial differences of class, privilege, location, and ethnicity that exist between women against the context of multinational corporate agendas and those of the nation-state's. Transnational feminist scholars critique the dominant tenets of a Western feminism that disavow the subjectivity and agency of marginalized women, contesting at the same time the terms of a Western postmodernism that would elide the narratives and experiences of those in the global South.

Within Asian American studies, the "transnational turn" has also been the subject of many articles (R. Leong 1989; Hune 1989; Mazumdar 1991; Collet and Lien 2009). A transnational emphasis in this field has been shaped by factors such as post-1965 immigration

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patterns and an upsurge of scholars who analyze communities, cultures, and politics within transnational frameworks. In earlier strands of the debate, some Asian Americanists have decried this move to "denationalize" Asian American studies, which displaces the U.S. as a site of critique for the problems of classism, sexism, and heterosexism that take root within U.S. borders (S. Wong 1995). Other scholars are also critical of this direction in the discipline because of the ways that it dislodges questions of race and coalition building in the formation of Asian American communities (D. Li 2000).

However, for another group of critics, the notion that "Asians on the rim" constitutes a swathe of subjects whose trajectories necessarily interweave with a multitude of different types of histories is an important consideration. As Arif Dirlik (1996) notes, this consideration, however, must also be deeply attentive to the local in order to oppose the global, most especially in the guise of global capitalism. Responding to these debates, scholars argue that a progressive political project can indeed be achieved through the lens of transnationalism as a way to critique U.S.-centrism and the kinds of nationalisms that occur at home and abroad, within both the local and global (C. Lee 2005). Moreover, rather than an either/or approach to national and transnational concerns, Asian American scholars are encouraged to use a multipronged approach in tracing the lives and livelihoods of Asians in the Americas and other parts of the world (J. Okamura 2003).

Debates about transnationalism show the recent investment that scholars have in a mode of analysis that goes beyond the logics and reach of the nation-state. Nonetheless, for transnationalism to remain a critical term, it must also be allied with a hyperawareness of its alignments with global capitalism and appropriations of minority politics and identities. Further, transnationalism, as a process, concept, and methodology, must always be defined in relation to a historically specific context of cross-border processes and thus tend to the imbalanced relations of power as well as systems of knowledge that often undergird transnational movement. In this way, transnationalism can be used as an effective critique of local and global forms of power, serving as "a strategic research site" that tracks cultural productions, community formations, social movements, and political change within multiple contexts (Faist 2010).

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